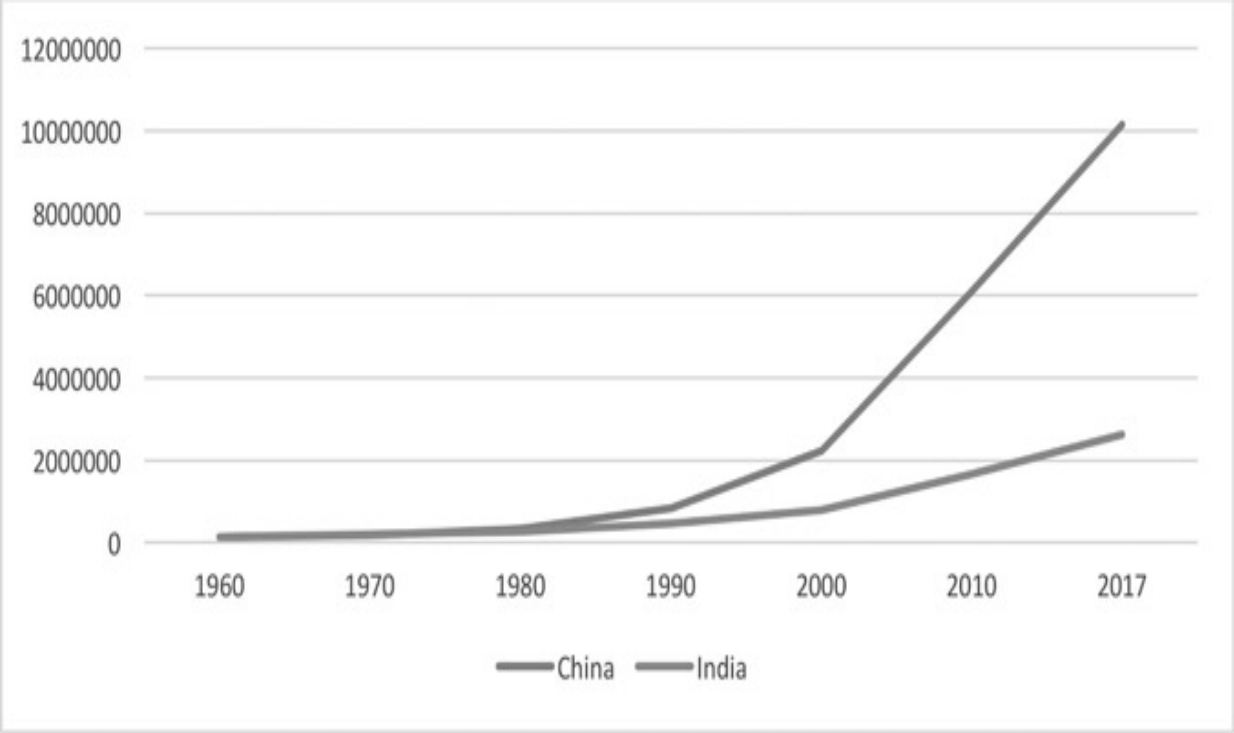



**FIGURE 2.1** China and India GDP compared 1960–2017 (constant 2010 USD, in billions)
*Source:* World Bank (2018) *World Development Indicators*, available at http://databank.worldbank.org/data/reports.aspx?source=world-development-indicators

With more than 600,000 Soviet troops deployed along China's northern border by the early 1980s, a force that included nuclear-tipped SS-20 missiles,[53] the Soviet Union constituted a larger threat than India to Chinese interests. As a consequence, Beijing in the late 1970s and early 1980s made several attempts at improving relations with India in order to dismantle the Soviet encirclement of China. First in the late 1970s, and then again in 1981, Foreign Minister Huang Hua visited New Delhi; these were the first minister-level Chinese official visits to India since Zhou Enlai's in 1960. The same year, China and India also started negotiations towards a settlement of their border dispute. China, however, approached India on the condition of "delinking" improvements in Sino–Indian relations from their border dispute and China's friendship with Pakistan and other countries in South Asia.[54] It meant that India would